BRAIN 07

Noopept

Ethyl ester of N-phenylacetyl-L-prolylglycine (omberacetam), a small dipeptide-like molecule from Russia



CLASS	STUDIED FOR	HUMAN EVIDENCE	US STATUS
Dipeptide-like small molecule	Mild thinking problems after brain injury	Small human studies	Not FDA approved

STUDIED FOR

- **Memory after stroke** — HUMAN
- **Brain-wave changes** — HUMAN
- **Memory in rodents** — ANIMAL
- **Nerve growth factors** — ANIMAL

Human data are limited. A few small Russian studies, mostly in Russian. No trial is registered on ClinicalTrials.gov.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Noopept → NGF and BDNF genes → Hippocampus → Memory

- **In rats,** raised activity of the NGF and BDNF genes in the hippocampus
- **In mice,** prevented the memory deficit caused by scopolamine
- **In people,** the mechanism is not established

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

SMALL HUMAN
LEVEL 3 OF 5

- Small Russian studies, 2008 to 2011
- Open study of 60 stroke patients
- No registered trial

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Long-term safety
- Half-life in people
- Side-effect profile
- Effects in healthy men

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE	ROUTES STUDIED
Not established in people	By mouth in Russian studies
PHARMACOKINETICS	**SOLD AS**
Not established	Not FDA approved; FDA cited supplements containing it (2019)
MONITORED IN TRIALS	**SPORT (WADA)**
MMSE, word-association tests, EEG	Not on the 2026 list

REGULATORY					
FDA	Not approved; cited in 2019 warning letters	TGA	Prescription-only (Schedule 4); not authorised	EMA	Not authorised
WADA	Not named; S0 status not stated				

REFERENCES

1. FDA, health fraud page on Alzheimer's disease products, Nov 2026
2. Neurol Clin Pract, omberacetam and analogs in supplements, Jun 2021
3. J Xenobiot, medicines control laboratories on noopept, Jun 2025

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